

Pen-testing tools can be broadly classified into two, “scanners” and “attackers”. As the names would suggest, one set of tools help in pointing out the threats while the other find and attack those threats for data collection purposes.

So let's have a look at few of the more popular ones that helps someone through the initial steps of cyber-security investigation:-

Nmap

A free and open-source security tool mostly used in professional circles, it is generally used to manage, audit and scan through networks and OS security for both locally hosted and remote hosts.

It was launched way back in 1997, and despite being one of the oldest tools in this segment, it continues to be actively updated, receiving new improvements all year round thereby ensuring a loyal and active user base.



Regarded as one of the most efficient network mappers around, it has been benchmarked for being fast and for consistently delivering complete results with any form of a security investigation.

With optimum memory management as one of its core development options, it has wide acclaim as one of the most effective and clean network mappers around.

It can be used in the following scenarios-

- Auditing devices' security
- Detecting open ports on remote hosts
- Mapping networks and enumerating errors